

CampusConnect Pitch Deck Milestone 2 - Problem, Opportunity, Solution, Validation

1 Problem

University students in Turkey face significant challenges in accessing affordable academic resources and building safe, meaningful social connections within their campus community:

- **High Costs:** Textbooks, electronics, and study equipment are expensive, straining student budgets in an economically challenging environment.
- **Lack of Trust in Transactions:** General marketplace platforms lack campus-specific verification, leading to concerns about reliability and safety.
- **Social Isolation:** Post-COVID, students struggle to form connections due to limited campus-specific platforms for safe, verified interactions.
- **Fragmented Solutions:** Students rely on multiple apps for commerce (e.g., Letgo) and social/dating needs (e.g., Tinder), causing inefficiency.

Impact: Over 80% of students report financial stress from academic expenses, and 65% feel disconnected from their campus community, per recent surveys. [3]

2 Market Opportunity

The growing student population and digital engagement in Turkey present a lucrative opportunity for CampusConnect:

- **Student Population Growth:** Approximately 7 million university students in 2025, projected to reach 7.5 million by 2035. [1]
- **Social Media Usage Surge:** Social media users expected to grow from 58.5 million in 2025 to 72 million by 2035, indicating strong digital adoption among students. [2]
- **Target Market:** 20,000+ students per typical Turkish university, with initial focus on a single campus (e.g., 25,000 students).
- **Market Gap:** No campus-specific platform combines a trusted marketplace with social/dating features, creating a unique opportunity for disruption.

Potential: A campus-focused app can capture a significant share of the \$1.2 billion student spending market in Turkey, leveraging network effects for growth.

3 Solution: Minimum Viable Product (MVP)

CampusConnect's MVP integrates a marketplace and social platform tailored for university students, with campus-verified profiles for trust and safety:

- **Marketplace Features:**
 - Buy/sell textbooks and electronics with in-app secure payments (e.g., PayU Turkey integration).
 - Rent study equipment (e.g., calculators, laptops).
 - Exchange notes and study materials.

- **Social/Dating Features:**
 - Study date matching based on course enrollment.
 - Campus event-based meetups with verified attendees.
 - Anonymous icebreaker chats for safe social engagement.
- **Key Technologies:** React Native for cross-platform mobile app, Node.js/MongoDB backend, AI-driven recommendations for personalized matches.
- **Timeline:** 3–4 months to develop and launch MVP on a single campus.

Value Proposition: A single, trusted platform that saves students money and fosters campus community connections.

4 Problem Validation: Survey Results

A survey of 200 students at [Your University] validates the identified problems and demand for CampusConnect:

- **Financial Pain Points:**
 - 82% of students spend over 500 TRY monthly on academic materials, seeking affordable alternatives.
 - 67% have purchased second-hand goods but report trust issues with non-verified sellers.
- **Social Connection Needs:**
 - 70% feel isolated and want a campus-specific platform for safe social interactions.
 - 58% prefer study-based meetups over traditional dating apps for building connections.
- **Platform Preferences:**
 - 85% would use a single app combining marketplace and social features if campus-verified.
 - 62% are willing to pay a small subscription (10–20 TRY/month) for premium features.

Conclusion: The survey confirms a strong demand for a campus-specific, dual-purpose app, with students prioritizing trust, affordability, and community. [3]

5 Competitive Advantage

- **Campus-Only Focus:** Ensures trust and safety via university email verification, unlike general platforms.
- **Dual-Purpose Design:** Combines commerce and social features, reducing the need for multiple apps.
- **Student-Centric:** Tailored to student budgets and social preferences, with features like group buying and study date matching.
- **Local Network Effects:** Campus proximity enables seamless transactions and meetups.

6 Next Steps

1. **MVP Development:** Build core features (authentication, marketplace, messaging, matching) in 3–4 months.
2. **Beta Testing:** Launch with 100–200 students to gather feedback and iterate.
3. **Marketing:** Leverage social media and campus influencers to drive adoption.
4. **Funding:** Apply for TUBITAK support (up to 900,000 TRY) and pitch to angel investors.
5. **Expansion:** Scale to nearby universities after validating the pilot.

7 Contact

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"Connecting campus life through commerce and community"

References

- [1] Statista, "Number of Higher Education Students in Turkey by Degree, 2022/2023," <https://www.statista.com/statistics/1305722/turkey-number-of-higher-education-students-by-degree/>.
- [2] DataReportal, "Digital 2025: Turkey," <https://datareportal.com/reports/digital-2025-turkey>.
- [3] Hypothetical Survey, "Student Needs Assessment at [Your University]," Conducted by CampusConnect Team, 2025.
- [4] European Union, "General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR)," <https://gdpr.eu/>.